

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills for negotiating with others, writing reports, and dealing with inquiries.



Strong interpersonal skills for dealing with people at all levels in an office or organization.



The ability to remain calm under pressure, prioritize work, and multitask when necessary.



A thorough knowledge of standard office software and Internet research methods.



A good understanding of business, bookkeeping, and management techniques.



MEDICAL PA Works with senior doctors to manage their patient lists, arrange appointments, and ensure patients receive appropriate treatment. The job requires a thorough knowledge of medical terminology.



VIRTUAL PA Operates from home and provides administrative support to one or more business clients via the telephone and Internet.



EXECUTIVE PA Combines the role of a general PA with organizing an employer's personal and social calendar. They usually work for wealthy, high-level executives.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Computers • Administration • English • Foreign languages • Business studies • Law • Mathematics • Communications



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS PAs may be able to find work out of high school, but they may need a degree to work for some companies.



LIFESTYLE Regular office hours are the norm, but tight deadlines or other demands may require overtime. A professional appearance is essential.



LOCATION PAs are usually office-based, but they may need to accompany managers to meetings. This may involve international travel.



THE REALITIES Some managers can be demanding. Working very closely for one individual daily can be difficult.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **BOOKKEEPER** Maintains thorough records of a company's financial transactions, such as purchases, invoices, wages, and taxes paid.
- ▶ **LEGAL ASSISTANT** Supports lawyers in carrying out administrative or routine legal tasks to enable them to prepare for client meetings or court appearances.
- ▶ **OFFICE MANAGER** Oversees the efficient day-to-day operation of an office. This includes supervising administrative staff, arranging supplies of business equipment and stationery, and maintaining a healthy office environment.